



Cambridge IGCSE™

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/11

Paper 1 Reading

May/June 2024

INSERT

2 hours

INFORMATION

- This insert contains the reading texts.
- You may annotate this insert and use the blank spaces for planning. **Do not write your answers** on the insert.

3662771179-1



This document has **8** pages. Any blank pages are indicated.

Read **Text A**, and then answer **Questions 1(a)–(e)** on the question paper.

Text A: Unusual modes of travel

Travelling the world can be thrilling – search online and you'll find lots more interesting ways to get around than cars, buses or planes. From trains made of bamboo to wicker toboggans, or even sleds pulled by trained dogs, these unusual types of transport offer an unforgettable experience.

Here are some more you might not have heard about ...

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Coco Taxi – Havana, Cuba: these tricycles, worked by pedal power, have a back seat for two people behind the driver. Some have a tiny motor that helps the driver when going up a slope. These cute yellow taxis shaped like hollow coconuts can be seen in Havana and in Varadero. Though prone to accidents, they are faster at negotiating traffic than regular taxis. The black taxis are used by locals, while the yellow ones are used by tourists.

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Monte Toboggan – Madeira, Portugal: originally a fast means of transport down to Funchal for people living in Monte, these toboggan sledges appeared around 1850. Still in use by locals today, they attract thousands of tourists every year who want to enjoy this exciting ride, sliding at high speed on narrow, winding streets down to Funchal. These two-seater wicker sledges glide on wooden runners and are pushed and steered by men dressed in white cotton clothes and straw hats, according to custom, using their rubber-soled boots as brakes. The downhill journey lasts about 10 minutes on a total course of 2 kilometres, reaching speeds of 48 kilometres per hour! Simple, yet effective. It's the perfect contrast to the high-technology cable car going slowly up to Monte.

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DUKW – London, UK: these amphibious trucks (known as DUKW – pronounced 'duck') though originally designed as military vehicles to run over both land and water, now offer friendlier rides past famous London landmarks before launching into the River Thames to get views from the water.

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Remember, it's not only the place that attracts tourists but also the unusual modes of transport found there – usually just as safe and often more reliable than regular options (though do your research beforehand). Prices can vary and so we recommend you agree on one before beginning any journey, booking your tickets or driver in advance wherever possible to avoid long queues or disappointment.

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Read **Text B**, and then answer **Question 1(f)** on the question paper.

Text B: The Hyperloop high-speed transport system

This online article, written in 2021, gives the writer's opinion of a proposed new transportation system.

I presume you've all heard of the Hyperloop concept – a supposedly less-polluting transport service carrying passengers inside giant low-pressure tubes in convoys of small pods at insane speeds. The 'train', powered along by magnets, floats on an air-cushion. No? Well don't worry, you can forget it: it's never going to happen.

Having read all the publicly available documents promoting its cost-effectiveness to run, it's quite clear that there's a huge gap between the exciting theory of this futuristic transportation, and it actually existing. Too many unknowns need to be discovered gradually, at great expense, before the technology can be applied to the design of a reliable transportation mode.

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The science behind Hyperloop appears sound enough, but we know that in reality things can go wrong. Multiple things could go wrong with Hyperloops (below, or even way above, ground since they can climb and simply go straight over obstacles apparently). A big question is the air-cushion, whose flow could be stopped by any sort of disturbance external to the tube. For example, oil pipelines fail, and it sure isn't the oil inside that's breaking them.

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Another enormous fault with the concept is that nobody nowadays needs to save one hour to get from one city to another. Mobile wi-fi means there's no such thing as unproductive time anymore. This has clearly escaped 'Hyperloopers', dazzled by the elegant design. That isn't to say that suction-tube transport can't work, but rather that we don't know enough to agree that it will work reliably and efficiently. Travelling in a tube might also not be the comfortable experience imagined, due to nausea-inducing acceleration.

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Hyperloop companies won't be the first to try transporting people in a sealed tube, they point out reassuringly. In 1867, the inventor Alfred Ely Beach wanted to build an underground train system that relied on pneumatic tubes. But Beach abandoned his passenger system, instead focusing on the easier task of moving mail. More sensible investors in Hyperloop projects argue its potential as a cargo transportation system between countries, perhaps beneath water. Think about it, if a pod full of cereals ever broke, would it even make the news?

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Read **Text C**, and then answer **Questions 2(a)–(d)** and **Question 3** on the question paper.

Text C: Riding the rails: learning how to drive a dog-sled

In this article, journalist Lyn Marshall looks back at her adventure holiday in Alaska.

As the sky gradually turned indigo in the fading light, the scraping of ice and frantic unheeded commands to my sled dog-team broke the stillness. Thundering down the frozen waterway, I snatched anxious glimpses over my shoulder. Where was Mike, my guide? Would his tracker still pick up my signal with the gap between us increasing by the minute?

Out exploring that Friday evening, an irresistible scent had wafted by my lead dog's keen nose. Following primal instincts over my feeble instructions, he'd wheeled around, leading his obliging pack in the opposite direction at full speed! Applying all my weight to the hook brake saved me from fishtailing wildly from side to side but did nothing to slow the dogs' enthusiastic charge.

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From my evening chats with Mike over the last few days, I knew that if we lost each other entirely, I was in trouble. I had nothing – no extra clothing, no shelter, but more importantly, nothing to start a fire. We'd seen wolf tracks regularly, so fire seemed particularly important to me at that moment.

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* * *

It was March, the tail end of the long, cold winter. Roads were closed, rivers were frozen, and access into the region was limited.

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Still spellbound from gazing at the enormity of the Alaskan wilderness, I'd stepped down from the mail-plane into the miniature perfection of Eagle, a fascinating, history-packed hamlet of timber dwellings, home to just 85 residents. I was immediately wrapped in the customary bear hug by Mike's wife, Scarlett, and cocooned in layers of Arctic-grade outerwear.

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Mike and Scarlett live sustainably, hunting, fishing and gathering, consciously leaving a minimal carbon footprint. They've enjoyed many years of wilderness expeditions using traditional dog-sleds and now provide opportunities for adventurous souls to experience their eco-lifestyle first hand.

Driving a dog-sled is harder than it looks. As Mike's passenger, I realised it involved constant corrective manoeuvres anticipating the dog-team's next move (they only ever do what they want to) and possible camber (tilt in the trail).

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In theory lessons, Mike's diagrams emphasised that the 'ice highway' can be anything from porcelain smooth to oversized ice cubes (slam into one of those and you'd need your emergency messaging device), but winding through spruce forests tracing soft, snow-covered lines is a precious delight. Criss-crossing a small lake's glassy surface, I looked down to see exquisite designs – crystal bubbles of all shapes and sizes suspended in time, cascading into the dark depths.

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There were, of course, many thrills and spills. Losing control on one adrenalin-charged downhill run, I tipped sideways onto the snow. My happy, yappy team continued on, their inept operator hanging on single-handedly, thankful for the padded trousers provided.

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Each evening, we settled in at a different location, often an old miner's cabin, where our teams were secured and cared for. The teams are your lifeline, your escape route, so their health and wellbeing are paramount. Only after this did we collect snow for our water and cut firewood.

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The most memorable night? Using only nature's materials, we shovelled and hacked, creating a shelter against the sub-zero temperature. A reflective wall of logs threw the pit-fire's heat under our makeshift roof as Mike spoke with passion about life out here, the joy of relative freedom and the Aurora Borealis in the night skies that were nature's artwork: a ceiling of stars on dark nights, or flooded with rippling, emerald green curtains. As I burrowed down for the night, fire crackling in the stillness, the howling of wolves drifted to us. It was a moment of complete and utter contentment.

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* * *

Exactly how far I travelled through the twilight with my errant team, I'll never know. Our detour didn't have a dramatic end in the fangs of a wolf pack. Only when fatigued did the team slow, gliding to a halt with Mike rounding the bend sometime later to locate me.

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0500/11

May/June 2024

2 hours

You must answer on the question paper.

You will need: Insert (enclosed)

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer **all** questions.
- Use a black or dark blue pen.
- Write your name, centre number and candidate number in the boxes at the top of the page.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- Do **not** use an erasable pen or correction fluid.
- Do **not** write on any bar codes.
- If additional space is needed, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet; the question number or numbers must be clearly shown.
- Dictionaries are **not** allowed.

INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 80.
- The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [].
- The insert contains the reading texts.

This document has **16** pages. Any blank pages are indicated.



Read **Text A, *Unusual modes of travel***, in the insert and then answer **Questions 1(a)–(e)** on this question paper.

Question 1

(a) Give the **three** ways to travel that we might find 'more interesting' according to the text.

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[1]

(b) Using your own words, explain what the text means by:

(i) 'unusual types' (line 3)

..... [2]

(ii) 'unforgettable experience' (lines 3 and 4)

..... [2]

(c) Re-read paragraph 3 ('Coco Taxi □ tourists.').

Give **two** different reasons why Coco Taxi might appeal to tourists.

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[2]

(d) Re-read paragraph 4 ('Monte Toboggan □ to Monte.').

(i) Identify **two** features of the Monte Toboggan ride that might particularly appeal to tourists looking for a traditional transport experience.

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[2]

(ii) Explain why the Monte Toboggan ride might be of concern to more cautious tourists.

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[3]

- (e) Re-read paragraphs 5 and 6 ('DUKW □ disappointment.').

Using your own words, explain why some tourists might prefer to avoid using unusual modes of transport such as DUKWs while travelling.

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[3]

Read **Text B, *The Hyperloop high-speed transport system***, in the insert and then answer **Question 1(f)** on this question paper.

- (f) According to Text B, what might supporters of the Hyperloop consider to be its advantages and appeal?

You must use **continuous writing** (not note form) and **use your own words** as far as possible.

Your summary should not be more than 120 words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 5 marks for the quality of your writing.

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[Total: 30]

Read Text C, *Riding the rails: learning how to drive a dog-sled*, in the insert and then answer Questions 2(a)–(d) on this question paper.

Question 2

(a) Identify a word or phrase from the text which suggests the same idea as the words underlined:

(i) One of Lyn's dog-team was distracted by what it found to be an overpoweringly attractive smell.

..... [1]

(ii) The lead dog did not listen to Lyn's commands because its natural urges were to follow the smell.

..... [1]

(iii) Using the brake did not help Lyn to control the excited rush forwards of the dogs pulling her sled.

..... [1]

(iv) Lyn's hosts organised their lives to have the smallest possible impact on the environment.

..... [1]

(b) Using your own words, explain what the writer means by each of the words underlined:

As the sky gradually turned indigo in the fading light, the scraping of ice and frantic unheeded commands to my sled dog-team broke the stillness. Thundering down the frozen waterway, I snatched anxious glimpses over my shoulder. Where was Mike, my guide? Would his tracker still pick up my signal with the gap between us increasing by the minute?

(i) gradually [1]

(ii) unheeded [1]

(iii) glimpses [1]

- (c) Use **one** example from the text below to explain how the writer suggests her feelings when she first arrived in Eagle.

Use your own words in your explanation.

Still spellbound from gazing at the enormity of the Alaskan wilderness, I'd stepped down from the mail-plane into the miniature perfection of Eagle, a fascinating, history-packed hamlet of timber dwellings, home to just 85 residents. I was immediately wrapped in the customary bear hug by Mike's wife, Scarlett, and cocooned in layers of Arctic-grade outerwear.

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[3]

(d) Re-read paragraphs 8 and 11.

- Paragraph 8 begins 'In theory lessons, ...' and is about riding on the snow and ice.
- Paragraph 11 begins 'The most memorable □ ' and is about the writer's feelings that night.

Explain how the writer uses language to convey meaning and to create effect in these paragraphs. Choose **three** examples of words or phrases from **each** paragraph to support your answer. Your choices should include the use of imagery.

Write about 200 to 300 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer.

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Re-read **Text C, *Riding the rails: learning how to drive a dog-sled***, in the insert and then answer **Question 3** on this question paper.

Question 3

You are Mike. The Ultimate Experience Travel Company which advertises your expeditions has seen Lyn Marshall's article reviewing her holiday in Alaska and has some concerns about the expedition and about using dogs to pull sleds. The company has asked you for a formal report.

In your report you should:

- explain exactly what happened during the evening exploration **and** the measures you take to ensure the safety and comfort of tourists
- remind the company of the different things tourists enjoy about the holiday you offer **and** why
- reassure the company that its various concerns about using dogs to pull sleds are unfounded **and** explain why you think that this form of transport is important to protect.

Write the words of the report.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 10 marks for the quality of your writing.

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[25]

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This image shows a full page of a handwriting practice worksheet. It consists of multiple sets of three horizontal dashed lines, providing a guide for letter height and placement. The lines are evenly spaced across the entire page, leaving ample room for writing practice. There is no text or other markings on the page.

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